Depressive and Bipolar Disorders

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Learn With PsycLearn Essentials

Module 2
Opening to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders

Lesson 1: Culture and Mood Disorders
- ✓ Focus of the Course
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Classifying Psychopathology
  Reading • 4 min
- ✓ Culture and Psychopathology
  Reading • 4 min
- ✓ Culture and Intersectionality
  Reading • 4 min
- ✓ Culture and Stigma
  Reading • 4 min
- ✓ Check Your Understanding: Culture and Mood Disorders
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%

Lesson 2: Introduction to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
- ✓ Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Video • 6 min
- ✓ Living with a Mood Disorder: A Case Study
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Overview of Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Check Your Understanding: Introduction to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 80%

Key Takeaways
- ✓ Key Takeaways: Opening to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Reading • 10 min

Module 2 Quiz
- ✓ Module Quiz: Opening to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Graded Assignment • Grade: 87.5%

Module 3
Depressive and Bipolar Disorders

Lesson 3: Overview of Depressive Disorders
- ✓ Depression: A Case Study
  Reading • 5 min
- ✓ What Does Depression Feel Like?
  Reading • 7 min
- ✓ Diagnostic Criteria and Prevalence for Depressive Disorders
  Reading • 5 min
- ○ Check Your Understanding: Overview of Depressive Disorders
  Practice Assignment • 12 min

Lesson 4: Overview of Bipolar Disorders
- ✓ Bipolar: A Case Study
  Reading • 5 min
- ✓ What Does Bipolar Feel Like?
  Reading • 7 min
- ✓ Diagnostic Criteria and Prevalence for Bipolar Disorders
  Reading • 5 min
- ✓ Check Your Understanding: Overview of Bipolar Disorders
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%

Key Takeaways
- ✓ Key Takeaways: Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Reading • 10 min

Module 3 Quiz
- ✓ Module Quiz: Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Graded Assignment • Grade: 87.5%

Module 4
Biological Contributing Factors

Lesson 5: Genetic Contributing Factors
- ✓ Developmental Psychopathology
  Reading • 3 min
- ○ **Genetic Contributing Factors**
  Reading • 3 min
- ○ The Link Between Genes and Psychopathology
  Video • 4 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Genetic Contributing Factors for Depression
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Epigenetic Contributors to Depression
  Video • 3 min
- ○ Genetic Contributing Factors for Bipolar Disorder
  Reading • 3 min
- ○ Check Your Understanding: Genetic Contributing Factors
  Practice Assignment • 4 min

Lesson 6: Neurobiological Contributing Factors
- ○ Depressive Disorders: A Case Study
  Reading • 5 min
- ○ Communication in the Synapse
  Video • 4 min
- ○ Neurochemical Contributors to Depression
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Hormonal Contributors to Depression
  Reading • 5 min
- ○ Brain Regions Linked to Depression
  Video • 4 min
- ○ Neurobiological Contributors to Depressive and Bipolar Disorders
  Reading • 15 min
- ○ Check Your Understanding: Biological Contributing Factors
  Practice Assignment • 6 min

Key Takeaways
- ○ Key Takeaways: Biological Contributing Factors
  Reading • 10 min

Module 4 Quiz
- ○ Module Quiz: Biological Contributing Factors
  Graded Assignment • 9 min

Module 5
Psychological Contributing Factors

Module 6
Treatments for Depressive and Bipolar Disorders

Module 7
Suicide

Module 8
Conclusion

Module 9
Cumulative Quiz

Module 10
Course Resources

Module 11
PsycLearn Essentials APA Student Resources

Genetic Contributing Factors

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Heritability and Concordance

Much of the research on psychological disorders seeks to examine genetic influences. Just as physical characteristics, such as height and hair color, run in families, psychological disorders can have genetic influences. The goal of genetic research is to determine whether the incidence of the disorder is due to a biological predisposition such as genes, environmental influences such as childhood trauma or interpersonal difficulties, or a combination of the two.

Heritability refers to a population estimate of the variability in the expression of a physical trait, such as hair texture, height, or eye color, as well as a psychological disorder, such as depression. Formally defined, **heritability** is a statistical estimate of the contribution of both inheritance and environment to a given trait in a population, but not in a particular individual. Heritability can range from 0%, indicating no contribution of heritable factors to an expressed trait, to 100%, indicating total contribution of heritable factors to an expressed trait.

Family and twin studies of depression have led to an estimate of a heritability rate for depressive disorders between 30% and 50% among identical twins. Identical twins share 100% of their genes, whereas fraternal twins share only 50% of their genes. When one identical twin has a depressive disorder there is an increased risk that the other twin will also develop depressive symptoms (McIntosh et al., 2019). The **concordance rate** is the percentage of twins or other blood relatives who exhibit a particular trait or disorder. Said another way, it is the probability that blood relatives will develop the same trait or disorder. If twins exhibit the same trait, they are said to be concordant, and if they do not exhibit the same trait, they are said to be discordant. If there is a genetic component to depression, then the concordance rate should be higher among identical twins than fraternal twins. This is indeed the case: among fraternal twins, who share only 50% of their genes, the heritability rate for depressive disorders is 15%-20% (Sullivan et al., 2000) and Kieseppa and colleagues (2004) observed that the concordance rate was 75% among identical twins and 11% among fraternal twins.

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